ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION

# REPORT

## ON THE BY-ELECTIONS HELD ON THE 25TH OF OCTOBER 2025

## Ward 21 of Chimanimani RDC
## Ward 4 of Gutu RDC and
## Ward 12 of Mangwe RDC

**Executive Summary**

1. The Zimbabwe Electoral Commission (ZEC) is an Election Management Body (EMB) established in terms of Section 238 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe.

2. Its functions are provided for in *Section 239* of the said Constitution.

3. Following the notification of the local authority vacancies which arose in Wards 21 of Chimanimani Rural District Council (RDC), 4 of Gutu RDC and 12 of Mangwe RDC, the Commission issued a **ZEC Notice on 8 September 2025** calling for by-elections to be held on 25 October 2025.

4. The Commission incurred expenses amounting to ZWG ZWG9 000 000 for the by-elections.

5. The Commission conducted voter education exercises for the pre-nomination and pre-polling phases. The key messages for pre-nomination voter education focused on what caused the by-elections and the qualifications for aspiring candidates. The pre-polling messages focused on how to vote.

6. The Nomination Courts to receive nomination papers for aspiring candidates to stand for election as Councillors sat on 24 September 2025.

   At the close of the sitting of the Nomination Courts, the results were as follows:

**Persons Nominated for Election**

| Local Authority | Ward | Candidate | Sex | Sponsoring Party |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Chimanimani RDC | 21 | Chitendeva Janet | F | NCA |
| | | Hlerema Chipo | F | ZANU PF |
| | | | | |
| Gutu RDC | 4 | Manguvo Farai | M | Independent |
| | | Mutare Tawanda | M | ZANU PF |
| | | | | |
| Mangwe RDC | 12 | Moyo Tshaka | M | Independent |
| | | Ndlovu Benjamini | M | ZANU PF |

7. A total of six thousand seven hundred (6 700) ballot papers were printed for the local authority by-elections. This information was publicised in terms of the law.

8. The Commission established seventeen (17) polling stations for voting purposes. This information was publicised in terms of the law.

9 The Commission mostly used its own fleet of vehicles for the by-elections and hired one tractor to navigate the mountainous and wet terrain of Rusitu in Chimanimani, Manicaland.

10. The training of electoral officers was conducted from 13 to 23 October 2025.

11. The Commission received an application for the accreditation of observers.

12. The by-elections were held on 25 October 2025 and results were announced on the same day.

13. Below is a Schedule of local authority candidates that were declared winners after the polls: -

| **Local Authority** | **Ward** | **Winner** | **Sex** | **Party** |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Chimanimani RDC | 21 | Hlerema Chipo | F | ZANU PF |
| Gutu RDC | 4 | Mutare Tawanda | M | ZANU PF |
| Mangwe RDC | 12 | Ndlovu Benjamini | M | ZANU PF |

14. The 25th of October 2025 by-elections were held under peaceful conditions and no cases of politically motivated incidents were received by the Commission.

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# Part 1

## THE ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION

### 1.1 Composition

The Zimbabwe Electoral Commission (ZEC) is an Election Management Body (EMB) established in terms of the section 238 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe.

It is composed of a Chairperson appointed by the President after consultation with the Judicial Service Commission and the Committee on Standing Rules and Orders and eight other members appointed by the President from a list of not fewer than twelve nominees submitted by the Committee on Standing Rules and Orders.

At the time of the by-elections, the Commission consisted of a board of eight members as follows:

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | Honourable Mrs Justice Priscilla Makanyara Chigumba | - | Chairperson |
| 2. | Ambassador Rodney Simukai Kiwa | - | Deputy Chairperson |
| 3. | Mrs Abigail Millicent Mohadi- Ambrose | - | Commissioner |
| 4. | Ms Catherine Mpofu | - | Commissioner |
| 5. | Mrs Rosewita Murutare | - | Commissioner |
| 6. | Mr Jasper Mangwana | - | Commissioner |
| 7. | Dr Janet Mbetu Nzvenga | - | Commissioner |
| 8. | Dr Kudzai Shava | - | Commissioner |

**1.2 Functions of the Commission**

The functions of the Zimbabwe Electoral Commission are provided for in section 239 of the Constitution as follows:

a. to prepare for, conduct and supervise –

   (i) elections to the office of President and to Parliament;

   (ii) elections to provincial and metropolitan councils and the governing bodies of local authorities;

   (iii) elections of Members of the National Council of Chiefs established by section 285; and

   (iv) referendums;

   and to ensure that those elections and referendums are conducted efficiently, freely, fairly, transparently and in accordance with the law,

b. to supervise elections of the President of the Senate and the Speaker and to ensure that these elections are conducted efficiently and in accordance with the law;

c. to register voters;

d. to compile voters' rolls and registers,

e. to ensure the proper custody and maintenance of voters rolls and registers;

f. to delimit constituencies, wards and other electoral boundaries;

g. to design, print and distribute ballot papers, approve the form of and procure ballot boxes, and establish and operate polling centres;

h. to conduct and supervise voter education;

i. to accredit observers of elections and referendums;

j. to give instructions to persons in the employment of the State or of a local authority for the purpose of ensuring the efficient, free, fair, proper and transparent conduct of any election or referendum; and

k. to receive and consider complaints from the public and to take such action in regard to the complaints as it considers appropriate.

### 1.3 Additional Functions

The Electoral Act [*Chapter 2:13*] in section 5 thereof provides for additional functions and powers of the Commission as follows:

a) undertaking and promoting research into electoral matters

b) developing expertise and the use of technology in regard to the electoral processes; and

c) promoting co-operation between Government, political parties and civil society in regard to elections; and

d) keeping the public informed about -

   i. the times and places where persons can register as voters and the progress of the voter registration exercise; and

   ii. the delimitation of wards, constituencies and other electoral boundaries, and

   iii. the location and boundaries of polling stations and when they are open for inspection; and

   iv. voters roll and the times and places at which they are open for inspection; and

   v. political parties and candidates contesting every election and;

   vi. voting; and

   vii. generally, all matters relating to the Commission's work and the electoral process; and

(d1) ensuring that gender is mainstreamed into electoral processes; and

(e) making recommendations to Parliament on appropriate ways to provide public financing for political parties.

# Part 2

## 2.1 BUDGET

The Commission incurred expenses amounting to ZWG9 000 000 for the 25 October 2025 by-elections.

## 2.2 Budget Control

The Commission applied all financial statutory guidelines as required by the law.

# Part 3

## 3.1 PREPARATIONS FOR THE BY-ELECTIONS

## 3.2 ZEC Notice of 8 September 2025

Following the notification of the local authority vacancies which arose in Wards 21 of Chimanimani RDC, 4 of Gutu RDC and 12 of Mangwe RDC, the Commission issued a **ZEC Notice on 8 September 2025** calling for by-elections to be held on 25 October 2025. The seats fell vacant by reason of death of the councillors who were duly elected during the 2023 Harmonised Elections. The Commission duly prepared for the by-elections in the Wards concerned.

## 3.3 Voter Education

The Commission conducted pre-nomination and pre-polling voter education for the said by-elections between 14 September and 20 October 2025. The key messages for the pre-nomination phase centred on what had caused the by-elections and who qualified to be a candidate in the elections. The pre-polling voter education notified the electorate of the contesting candidates, correct documentation to carry, the polling date and times, the voting process and how to cast a vote, assisted and redirected voters and encouraging the electorate to go and vote.

The voter education teams used various methodologies to educate the electorate. These included the door-to-door visits, interaction with individuals and addressing of gatherings, use of posters, distribution of pamphlets and flyers and use of the Public Address (PA) System.

## 3.4 Nomination Court Results

The Nomination Courts sat on 24 September 2025.

The following candidates were nominated for election at the close of the sitting of the Nomination Courts:

**Persons Nominated for Election**

| Local Authority | Ward | Candidate | Sex | Sponsoring Party |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Chimanimani RDC | 21 | Chitendeva Janet | F | NCA |
| | | Hlerema Chipo | F | ZANU PF |
| | | | | |
| Gutu RDC | 4 | Manguvo Farai | M | Independent |
| | | Mutare Tawanda | M | ZANU PF |
| | | | | |
| Mangwe RDC | 12 | Moyo Tshaka | M | Independent |
| | | Ndlovu Benjamini | M | ZANU PF |

### 3.5 Voter Registration

No voter registration was conducted prior to the sitting of the nomination courts owing to the fact that according to section 121A (3) of the Electoral Act [Chapter 2:13], the voters' roll closes on the day the vacancy arises for local authority by-elections.

### 3.6 Provision of voters rolls to Candidates

The contesting candidates were issued with copies of voters' roll for their respective Wards. An analysable electronic voters' roll was placed at respective provincial, district and ward centres for access by the public.

### 3.7 Multiparty Liaison Committees

An average of two (2) Multiparty Liaison Committee meetings were held in the districts and wards where by-elections were conducted. The meetings were successfully conducted and all outstanding issues concerning the conduct of the by-elections were resolved.

### 3.8 Polling Stations

A total of seventeen (17) polling stations were established in the Wards that had by-elections broken down as follows:

| Province | District | Local Authority | Ward | No. of Polling Stations |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Manicaland | Chimanimani | Chimanimani RDC | 21 | **6** |
| Masvingo | Gutu | Gutu RDC | 4 | **7** |
| Matabeleland South | Mangwe | Mangwe RDC | 12 | 4 |
| **Total** | | | | **17** |

### 3.9 Ballot Paper Printing

A total of six thousand seven hundred ballot papers (**6 700**) were printed for the 25 October 2025 by-elections by the Minting and Printing Company of Zimbabwe (PMCZ). This information was publicised in terms of the law.

### 3.10 Transport

The Commission largely used its own vehicle fleet for the by-elections. Each polling station was allocated a vehicle. In Manicaland, the Commission had to hire a tractor from the Rural Infrastructure and Development Authority (RIDA) to help navigate and shorten a 110-kilometre trip. This was necessitated by the poor state of the road, mountainous terrain exacerbated by the rains. This made the process of deployment, transmission of results and decamping manageable.

### 3.11 Recruitment, Training and Deployment of Electoral Officers

Personnel to conduct the by-elections were drawn from the host provinces that are Manicaland, Masvingo and Matabeleland South Provinces. The few seconded staff were drawn from the Civil Service Commission and the local authorities concerned. The recruitment of Ward Elections Officers and their deputies was done on time and same were trained between 16 and 17 October 2025. The training of Presiding Officers was conducted on the 19th and 20th of October 2025 while the Polling Officers were trained between the 22nd and 23rd of October 2025.

The deployment of electoral officers took place prior to their training sessions. Training for polling officers was done at polling station level. The Zimbabwe Republic Police (ZRP) officers were deployed alongside electoral staff to provide security. The setting up of polling stations and rehearsals were done a day before polling.

### 3.12 Accreditation of Observers and Media Personnel

The accreditation of observers for the by-election was conducted during the period 10 September to 25 October 2025.

# Part 4

## 4.1 CONDUCT OF ELECTION – POLLING

### 4.2 Polling

Polling took place on 25 October 2025 commencing from 0700 hours and ending at 1900 hours. Due regard was given to the provision that no voter in the queue of persons waiting to vote as at 1900 hours would be turned away.

All the polling stations were adequately staffed by electoral officers including agents and observers. The police details were deployed to provide security and performed other duties as provided by the law.

Only one (1) distinctly marked ballot box for a Ward by-election was set up in each polling station.

### 4.3 Assisted Voters

The below table shows the number by gender of persons assisted in the Wards during the by-elections: -

| **Local Authority** | **Assisted Voters** | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | Female | Male | **Total** |
| Chimanimani RDC Ward 21 | 80 | 18 | **98** |
| Gutu RDC Ward 4 | 34 | 21 | **55** |
| Mangwe RDC Ward 12 | 73 | 13 | **86** |
| **Total** | **187** | **52** | **239** |

The illiterate, the elderly and the visually challenged voters who were not able to vote without assistance were assisted by persons of their choice in compliance with the law. A person who did not bring an assistant was assisted by the Presiding Officer in the presence of two other officers and the police officer on duty.

## 4.4 Turned Away Voters

A total of two hundred and ninety-five (295) voters were turned away in the three (3) Wards broken down as follows: -

| **Local Authority** | **Turned Away Voters** | | **Total** |
|---|---|---|---|
| | **Female** | **Male** | |
| Chimanimani RDC Ward 21 | 112 | 84 | **196** |
| Gutu RDC Ward 4 | 20 | 13 | **33** |
| Mangwe RDC Ward 12 | 42 | 24 | **66** |
| **Total** | **174** | **121** | **295** |

The reasons for turning away voters were the non-possession of identity cards, wrong documents and not appearing on the voters' roll among others.

## 4.5 Verification and Counting

The counting of the votes was preceded by the verification of ballots which process was administered at polling station level by the Presiding Officers in the presence of candidates, observers and election agents. The verification and counting of polling station results was completed on the polling day.

## 4.6 Transmission and Results of Poll

The results were transmitted from the polling stations to the Ward Command Centre for collation. The Ward Elections Officers declared the results of the poll at the respective Ward Collation Centres. The polling station results were posted outside the polling stations and the collated results at the Ward Collation Centres.

The summary of the results for the by-elections was as shown in the table:

**25 OCTOBER 2025 BY-ELECTIONS RESULTS**

| Local Authority | Ward | Candidates | Sex | Party | Votes | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Chimanimani RDC | *21* | Chitendeva Janet | F | NCA | 93 | |
| | | Hlerema Chipo | F | ZANU PF | 982 | Winner |
| | | **Total Valid Votes Cast** | | | **1075** | |
| | | **Total Votes Rejected** | | | **10** | |
| | | **Ballot Paper Unaccounted for** | | | **0** | |
| | | **Total Votes Cast** | | | **1085** | |
| | | **Voter Population** | | | **2909** | |
| | | **Percentage Poll** | | | **37.3%** | |
| **Local Authority** | **Ward** | **Candidates** | **Sex** | **Party** | **Votes** | |
| Gutu RDC | 4 | Manguvo Farai | M | Independent | 53 | |
| | | Mutare Tawanda | M | ZANU PF | 800 | Winner |
| | | **Total Valid Votes Cast** | | | **853** | |
| | | **Total Votes Rejected** | | | **8** | |
| | | **Ballot Paper Unaccounted for** | | | **0** | |
| | | **Total Votes Cast** | | | **861** | |
| | | **Voter Population** | | | **2121** | |
| | | **Percentage Poll** | | | **40.6%** | |
| **Local Authority** | **Ward** | **Candidates** | **Sex** | **Party** | **Votes** | |
| Mangwe RDC | 12 | Moyo Tshaka | M | Independent | 137 | |
| | | Ndlovu Benjamini | M | ZANU PF | 463 | Winner |
| | | **Total Valid Votes Cast** | | | **600** | |
| | | **Total Votes Rejected** | | | **10** | |
| | | **Ballot Paper Unaccounted for** | | | **0** | |
| | | **Total Votes Cast** | | | **610** | |
| | | **Voter Population** | | | **1 286** | |
| | | **Percentage Poll** | | | **47.4%** | |

**Comparison of 2023 Harmonised Elections and 2025 By-elections Voter Turn-out**

| | Voter Population | | Percentage Poll | | % Variance |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Local Authority** | **2023** | **2025** | **2023** | **2025** | |
| Chimanimani RDC Ward 21 | 2 876 | 2 909 | 66.1% | 37.3% | **-28.8%** |
| Gutu RDC Ward 4 | 2 087 | 2 121 | 70.6% | 40.6% | **-30.0%** |
| Mangwe RDC Ward 12 | 1 261 | 1 286 | 56.6% | 47.4% | **-9.2%** |

Generally, there was a decrease in voter turn out for each of the by-election wards compared to that of the 2023 Harmonised elections as shown by the variances. The attributable factors for the low voter turn out could include voter apathy, the by-elections being perceived as of lesser importance and lacking high-stakes.

### 4.7 The Environment

The elections were held under calm and peaceful conditions. The Commission did not receive any report of politically motivated incidents.

# Part 5

## 5.1 OBSERVATIONS, RECOMMENDATIONS AND CONCLUSION

The Commission made observations and recommendations as presented below:

## 5.2 Payment of Allowances in Local Currency

Observation

The advance allowances were paid in local currency while most local shops traded in foreign currencies especially in the Matabeleland Province.

Recommendation

Electoral officials should be partially paid in foreign currency to alleviate the challenge.

## 5.3 Motor Vehicles

Observation

The current NP300 vehicle fleet has served two general elections. Its service and maintenance is now costly.

Recommendation

The Commission recommends that Treasury releases funding for the procurement of all-terrain vehicles and for the regular maintenance and servicing of vehicles.

## 5.4 Ward Boundary

Observation

Most voters had inadequate information about their polling area and ward boundaries following the creation of new boundaries occasioned by the 2022 Delimitation Exercise.

Recommendations

The Commission recommends the provision by Treasury of funding for the regular conduct of voter education on the 2022 Delimitation new ward and constituency boundaries

## 5.5 Conclusion

Generally, the 25 October 2025 by-elections were conducted in a peaceful manner. The Commission consulted and worked in collaboration with its stakeholders throughout the election period ensuring that the process was inclusive, transparent and credible.

The Commission was satisfied that the 25 October 2025 by-elections were conducted in a manner and under conditions that allowed voters to freely express their will.

Signed: ……. Date: ……....

Mrs Justice Priscilla Makanyara Chigumba

**ZEC Chairperson**

ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION



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